Sofia E. Mattson

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EDUCATION

M.S. Human-Environment Relations **2024 – 2026**
Cornell University, Department of Human Centered Design
Thesis: *Localizing Virtual Nature: Regional Familiarity and the Restorative Effects of VR Nature*
Cumulative GPA: 3.86

B.S. Psychology, *summa cum laude, Phi Beta Kappa, Honors with Distinction* **2017 – 2021**
University of Wisconsin – Milwaukee
Honors Capstone: *Working memory performance for differentially conditioned stimuli*
Cumulative GPA: 3.83

PUBLICATIONS

MANUSCRIPTS

Ward, R., Lotfi, S., Stout, D., **Mattson, S.,** Lee, H. J., & Larson, C. L. (2022). Working Memory Performance for Differentially Conditioned Stimuli. *Frontiers in Psychology.*

Ward, R., Lotfi, S., Stout, D., **Mattson, S.**, Lee, H. J., & Larson, C. L. (2021).Threatening words are efficiently filtered from working memory. *Biological Psychology*.

AUDIO

Creative Podcast: *Telyn Tales*

Mattson, S. Host. "Neuroscience Behind the Sound of Water." Telyn Tales on Acast. 2024 June 3. https://shows.acast.com/telyn-tales/episodes/neuroscience-behind-the-sound-of-water

Mattson, S. Host. "Trees Impact Cultural Identity and Behavior." Telyn Tales on Acast. 2023 Sep 11. https://shows.acast.com/telyn-tales/episodes/trees-impact-cultural-identity-and-ehavior

PROJECTS

Cornell Institute for Healthy Futures (2026). *CIHF Fall 2025 Roundtable Insights – Shaping Healthy Futures through Design & Technology*. (Written and designed by Sofia Mattson). Retrieved from https://bpb-us-e1.wpmucdn.com/blogs.cornell.edu/dist/6/10115/files/2026/02/CIHF-Insights-2025-Final-1.pdf.

CONFERENCE POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Mattson, S.,. Hsu, D. (2025). *Take the Guesswork Out of Plant Care and Poor Air: Plant-Remediated Indoor Air Filter and Quality Indicator.* Poster presentation, animation, and live demonstration given at the annual Cornell University Fashion and Design Expo.

Mattson, S., Shaw, C., Montoto, K., Kornkven, J., Siegel, E., Santiago, J., Ward, R., Larson, C. L. (2021). *Working memory performance for differentially-conditioned stimuli.* Poster presentation given virtually during the Psi Chi program at the 93rd Annual Meeting of the Midwestern Psychological Association.

Mattson, S., Shaw, C., Montoto, K., Kornkven, J., Siegel, E., Santiago, J., Ward, R., Larson, C. L. (2021). *Effects of differentially conditioned stimuli on working memory processes*. Poster presentation given at the annual University of Wisconsin – Milwaukee Undergraduate Research Symposium. Milwaukee, WI.

Santiago, J., **Mattson, S.**, Kornkven, J., Krause, A., Ramczyk, B., Lagunez-Garcia, J., Merrill, G., Shaw, C., Siegel, E., Athan, A., Schaefer, I., Thao, N., Steffes, M., Ward, R., & Larson, C. L. (2021). *How do neutral and threatening distracter words influence attention and working memory?* Poster presentation given at the annual University of Wisconsin – Milwaukee Undergraduate Research Symposium. Milwaukee, WI. Virtual conference due to COVID-19.

Mattson, S., Kornkven, J., Krause, A., Ramczyk, B., Lagunez-Garcia, J., Merrill, G., Shaw, C., Siegel, E., Athan, A., Schaefer, I., Steffes, M., Ward, R., & Larson, C. L. (2020). *Working memory filtering efficiency of threatening words.* Poster presentation accepted at the Association of Psychological Science annual convention. Chicago, IL.

Kornkven, K., **Mattson, S.**, Krause, A., Ramczyk, B., Lagunez-Garcia, J., Merril, G., Shaw, C., Siegel, E., Athan, A., Schaefer, I., Steffes, M., Ward, R., & Larson, C. L. (2020). *Are threatening words inefficiently filtered from gaining access to working memory?* Poster presentation given at the Wisconsin Psychological Association annual convention. Waukesha, WI.

Ward, R., **Mattson, S.**, Kornkven, J., Lotfi, S., Lee, H., & Larson, C. L. (2020). *Aversive distracter words and working memory filtering.* Poster presentation accepted at the Cognitive Neuroscience Society annual convention. Boston, MA.

Mattson, S., Kornkven, J., Krause, A., Lagunez-Garcia, J., Merrill, G., Shaw, C., Siegel, E., Athan, A., Schaefer, I., Steffes, M., Thao, N., Santiago, J., Ward, R., & Larson, C. L. (2020). *Filtering Efficiency of Threatening Words in Working Memory.* Poster

presentation accepted at the annual University of Wisconsin - Milwaukee Undergraduate Research Symposium. Milwaukee, WI.

Sallmann, H., **Mattson, S.,** Ginter, C., Sendek, M., Krause, A., Kornkven, J., Merrill, G., Ramczyk, B., Grimm, S., Ward, R., Larson, C. L. (2019). *Threat of shock reduces working memory capacity: An ERP study.* Poster presentation given at the annual University of Wisconsin - Milwaukee Undergraduate Research Symposium. Milwaukee, WI.

Sallmann, H., Ginter, C., Sendek, M., Krause, A., Kornkven, J., **Mattson, S.,** Merrill, G., Grimm, S., Ramczyk, B., Ward, R., & Larson, C. L. (2019). *Working memory capacity is reduced under threatening conditions: An ERP study.* Poster presentation given at National Conferences on Undergraduate Research annual convention. Kennesaw, GA.

CONFERENCE TALKS

Mattson, S. "Emerging Digital Landscapes for Climate Literature." Literary Climate Solutions Roundtable Session, 7–10 Jan. 2026, Toronto, Canada.

Mattson, S. (2023). *Beastly synchronicity and personal familiars.* Talk given at the University of Wisconsin – Milwaukee Honors College Beast Conference. Milwaukee, WI.

Mattson, S. (2021). *"Le Complainte de la Blanche Biche": A warning for women who wander in the wood.* Virtual talk given at the University of Wisconsin – Milwaukee Honors College Beast Conference. Milwaukee, WI.

Ward, R., **Mattson, S.**, Kornkven, J., Stout, D., Lotfi, S., Lee, H. J., & Larson, C. L. (2020). *Individual differences in filtering threat-related distracter words from working memory*. Talk accepted at the annual Association for Graduate Students in Psychology symposium at the University of Wisconsin – Milwaukee. Milwaukee. WI. Canceled due to COVID 19.

Mattson, S. (2019). *Grendel's raid: A poetic & instrumental interpretation on lever harp.* Creative presentation given at the University of Wisconsin – Milwaukee Honors College Monster Conference. Milwaukee, WI.

Mattson, S. (2019). *The demons that haunt us in bed: A neurophysiological and cultural analysis.* Oral presentation given at the University of Wisconsin - Milwaukee Honors College Monster Conference. Milwaukee, WI.

HONORS & AWARDS

Cornell Human-Centered Design Research Poster Contest - 2nd Prize	**2025**
Cornell College of Human Ecology Fashion & Design Expo	**2025**
Senior Excellence in Research Award (SERA)	**2020 – 2021**
Phi Beta Kappa Society	**2021**
College of Letters and Science Dean's List	**2017 – 2021**
Support for Undergraduate Research Fellows (SURF) Grant	**2019 – 2020**
UWM Chancellor's Award Scholarship	**2017**
Emmette and Kathleen Land Memorial Scholarship	**2017**
UWM Chancellor's Award Scholarship	**2017**
Illinois State Seal of Biliteracy in Spanish	**2017**

ORGANIZATIONS

PROFESSIONAL

American Psychological Association	**2020–Present**

INSTITUTION

Cornell University Big Red Barn Wellness Fellow	**2025**
Wisconsin Empathy Project	**2021–Present**
UWM Honors Association for Research and Publication	**2018 – 2021**
UWM Student Association	**2018**

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant **2024 – 2025**
Department of Human Centered Design
Designing Environments for Children and Adolescents (DECA) Lab
Cornell University
Supervisory: Dr. Janet E Loebach
Topics of focus: Youth-friendly community design, behavioral mapping, child-nature interaction, impacts of built environment on child development

Research Technician II – LTE **2020 – 2022**
Department of Psychology
Brain Imaging and Neuropsychology Laboratory: Adolescent Brain Cognitive Development (ABCD) Study
Supervisory: Dr. Krista Lisdahl
Advanced training in conducting psychiatric interviews, neuropsychological testing, collecting bioassays (e.g., hormone levels, DNA samples), and acquiring advanced multi

modal MRI scans

Lead Undergraduate Research Assistant **2018 – 2021**
Department of Psychology
Affective Neuroscience Laboratory
University of Wisconsin – Milwaukee
Supervisory: Christine L. Larson, PhD
Topics of Focus: Working memory capacity, working memory filtering efficiency, attentional inhibition, anxiety, impact of threat on cognitive task performance, aversive distracter words

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SKILLS

Software and Programming

- Adobe Suite
- Unity
- Qualtrics
- Python
- Midjourney
- Microsoft Excel
- Microsoft Visual Basic Code
- e-Prime 3.0
- JMP
- SPSS
- ERPLAB
- MATLAB
- REDCap data storage

Presentations

- Writing proficiency (including Spanish)
- Prepared oral, poster, and creative presentations (including Spanish language medical terminology)
- Public speaking
- Abstract formation
- Research proposal creation and presentation
- Research defense

Other Research Skills

- Organizational
    - Research assistant training
    - Scheduling
    - Lab maintenance
    - Recruitment
    - Fundraising

    - Data organization
- Qualitative analysis
- Quantitative Analysis
- Design
    - User-centered product design
    - Ambient environment components
    - Poster design
- Critical literature review
- Lab-specific:
    - ANT Neuro electroencephalogram (EEG) technology - 32 channels
    - IRB protocol
    - CITI Human Subjects Research
    - Biospecimen collection and preservation (hair, urine, saliva)
    - NicAlert
    - Dräger breathalyzer
    - MRI safety
    - Mock MRI setup, lead-through, & takedown

OTHER RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Student Administrative Assistant
Cornell Institute for Healthy Futures
2025 - present
Relevant Skills: Website design & maintenance, communications, and media for a broad-based platform combining hospitality, environmental design, & health policy to improve service in healthcare, wellness, and senior living

Teaching Assistant - DEA1112: Change Making - Designing Healthy & Hospitable Environments
Cornell Institute for Healthy Futures
Summer 2025
Relevant Skills: Assisting students with design thinking, architectural programming, & design for guest experience. Communication with guest speakers, adjusting teaching materials and presentations, Canvas posting, enrichening class discussion with relevant research and departmental connections.

Wellness Fellow
Cornell University Big Red Barn
2025 - present
Relevant Skills: Wellness event coordination and curation, communication, community building Partnering with Nature RX for a campus-wide mindful nature-walk monthly series.

Wisconsin Empathy Project Consortium
UW- Milwaukee
2021-present
Relevant Skills: Non-profit project coordination, interviewing, interview write-ups, sensitivity, listening, communication, community building, empathy

Independent Podcaster
Telyn Tales
2023-2024
Relevant Skills: interdisciplinary research, teaching, public speaking, audio, creativity, resilience, social media, online presence

Early Childhood Music Instructor
The Wisconsin Conservatory of Music
2022-2024
Relevant Skills: early childhood cognition, early childhood and parent instruction, early childhood musical abilities, low-income and unhoused families, musical tactics for cognitive sharpening, musical instruction, lesson planning, voice

HARPY Officer
UWM Honors Association for Research and Publication
2018-2021
Relevant Skills: research mentoring, research presentation, conference planning and coordination, social media curation, creativity, critical thinking, public speaking, recruitment

Principal Harpist
UWM Symphony Orchestra
2017-2021
Relevant Skills: time management, constructive criticism, detail-oriented, goal-setting, pattern finding, long-term project management, multiple project management, perseverance, problem solving, leadership

Student Development Supervisor
UWM Foundation
2018-2020
Relevant Skills: leadership, motivational speaking, communication coaching, interpersonal skill strategy, payroll, analyzing call-center statistics, computer skills, shift reports, office organization, overall call center operations, confidentiality

Psychology Department Representative
UWM Student Association
2018
Relevant Skills: research recruitment, communication, research advocacy, time-management, community building

Law Intern
Law Office of Michael P. Coghlan
2017
Relevant Skills: starting a LLC, application of research in business, contracts, time management, communication, business strategy

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REFERENCES

So-Yeon Yoon, PhD
Professor of Human-Centered Design
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Cornell University
3411 MVR Hall
Ithaca, NY

Saleh Kalantari, PhD
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210 Human Ecology Building
Ithaca, NY

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Milwaukee, WI

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